OPEN LETTER · STEVE PROTHERO · OWNER

Battery proposed for Greenway Terraces common property: questions on cost and consent

Sent 22 October 2026 · To The Executive Committee, Greenway Terraces (UP12457) · Response requested by 5 November 2026

22 October 2026

The Executive Committee, Owners Corporation UP12457 (Greenway Terraces)
Via Grady's Strata

Proposed common property battery: request for a full explanation

Dear Committee Members,

The October 2026 newsletter says a battery will be installed on the wall next to unit 15 within eight weeks by "Seene's contracted battery installer", and that "Once the battery is operational it will be charged by surplus solar power that cannot be sold to the grid." It will then power common property lighting, pool pumps, gates, cameras and BBQs.

I wrote about this on 20 October 2026 and have not yet had a reply. Before any further money is committed or work is done, I ask the Committee to explain in writing how this arrangement will work, and to answer the following.

The solar panels

Does the Owners Corporation own any solar panels today? If not, will the Committee buy its own panels to charge the battery?

If so, where on common property will they go, how many, at what total cost, and from which fund?

Where is the approval for the battery and for any panels: which general meeting or committee resolution, on what date, and for what amount? Please provide a copy.

"Surplus" electricity

Please explain fully what is meant by electricity that is "surplus" or "cannot be sold to the grid". Who generates it, at which meters, and what evidence (export limits, metering data, advice from Evoenergy or a retailer) shows it cannot be exported?
Who owns that electricity at the moment it is generated? If it comes from panels on individual townhouses, my understanding is that it belongs to the owner of those panels, not the Owners Corporation.
Has each owner whose electricity would be used given written consent for it to be moved into a battery for Owners Corporation use? On what terms, and will they be paid for it? Please provide the consent form or agreement and the number of owners who have signed.

Physically, how will electricity get from private lots to a common property battery? Has the wiring, metering and connection been approved by Evoenergy and certified by a licensed electrician?

Cost and value for owners

What is the full cost of the battery, installation, smart-meter upgrade and ongoing maintenance, and what is the expected saving, battery life and payback period? Please provide the quote(s) and any business case.

These questions matter to every owner. Common property money belongs to all 151 lots, and electricity generated on a private lot belongs to its owner unless there is a lawful agreement saying otherwise. Owners are entitled to see the approval, the cost and the legal basis before installation, not afterwards.

Please reply in writing within 14 days, with the documents requested, or tell me by when a full reply will be provided. I am happy to discuss this with the Energy Management Team. I restate if your communication was clearer and you answered questions there would not be the need for this back and forth, hopefully now XXXXXXXXXX we can get some common sense from the Committee about its communication or lack there of.

Yours sincerely,

Stephen Prothero
Lot Owner – Greenway Terraces (UP12457)

Steve Prothero · owner · https://steveprothero-cmyk.github.io/greenway-letters/l/2026-10-22-proposed-common-property-battery-request-for-a-full/